

Quantum Teleportation: Protocol, Implementation, and Applications

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Abstract

This report provides a comprehensive study of quantum teleportation, covering its protocol, implementation, and applications. We begin with an introduction to the fundamental concepts and historical development of quantum teleportation. We then present the theoretical framework and the step-by-step protocol for achieving quantum teleportation. Following this, we discuss various implementation strategies and their practical challenges. Finally, we explore the current and potential applications of quantum teleportation in quantum information processing and communication.

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I. INTRODUCTION

II. MATHEMATICAL BACKGROUND

A. Qubits and the Hilbert Space Formalism

The fundamental unit of quantum information is the "qubit". Unlike classical bit, which takes the value of either 0 or 1 at one of the time, a qubit exists in a two-dimensional Hilbert space $\mathcal{H} = \text{span}\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\} \cong \mathbb{C}^2$, and its state can be described by a unit vector with an orthonormal computational basis $\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\}$

$$|\psi\rangle = \alpha|0\rangle + \beta|1\rangle, \quad \alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{C}, \quad |\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1 \quad (1)$$

where α and β are the probability amplitudes: measurement yielding $|0\rangle$ or $|1\rangle$ has a probability $|\alpha|^2$ and $|\beta|^2$, respectively [1]. Unlike classical bit, a qubit can exist in a superposition of both states, which has no classical analogue. Physical realization of qubits include the two polarization of photon and two energy levels of an electron in an atom.

Bloch Sphere As an phase factor $e^{i\gamma}$ does not have observable effect, Eq. 1 can be written in a more general expression

$$|\psi\rangle = \cos \frac{\theta}{2} |0\rangle + e^{i\varphi} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} |1\rangle, \quad \theta \in [0, \pi], \quad \varphi \in [0, 2\pi) \quad (2)$$

The two parameters θ and φ define a unique point on the unit three-dimensional sphere, known as the Bloch sphere as shown in Figure 1. The north pole ($\theta = 0$) corresponds to $|0\rangle$, while the south pole corresponds to $|1\rangle$, and every point on the equator represents an equal superposition such as $|+\rangle = (|0\rangle + |1\rangle)/\sqrt{2}$.

Multi-qubit systems. For a system of two qubits, we use the tensor product of the individual Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}_{12} = \mathcal{H}_1 \otimes \mathcal{H}_2 \cong \mathbb{C}^4$ to represent the state space, with computational basis kets $\{|00\rangle, |01\rangle, |10\rangle, |11\rangle\}$. Here we use the ordering convention. That is, $|01\rangle = |0\rangle_1 \otimes |1\rangle_1$. Similarly, if it is a system of three qubits, then $|010\rangle = |0\rangle_1 \otimes |1\rangle_2 \otimes |0\rangle_3$. A general two-qubit state takes the form

$$|\psi\rangle = \alpha_{00} |00\rangle + \alpha_{01} |01\rangle + \alpha_{10} |10\rangle + \alpha_{11} |11\rangle, \quad \sum_x |\alpha_x|^2 = 1 \quad (3)$$

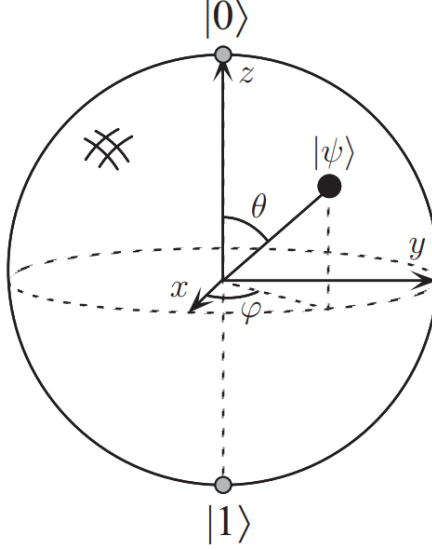


FIG. 1: Bloch sphere schematic. An arbitrary qubit can be represented by one point on the sphere [1].

B. Entanglement and the Bell States

A two-qubit state is called separable if it can be factored as $|\psi\phi\rangle = |\psi\rangle_A \otimes |\phi\rangle_B$. This means that qubit A is in state $|\psi\rangle$, while qubit B is in state $|\phi\rangle$. On the other hand, an entangled state can not be factorized into the product of two single-qubit states. In this case, the quantum state can only be understood as a property of the whole system. The most important entangled states for quantum teleportation are the Bell states [1, 2]

$$\begin{aligned} |\Phi^+\rangle &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |11\rangle), & |\Phi^-\rangle &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle - |11\rangle) \\ |\Psi^+\rangle &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|01\rangle + |10\rangle), & |\Psi^-\rangle &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|01\rangle - |10\rangle). \end{aligned} \quad (4)$$

These four states form an orthonormal basis for the two-qubit Hilbert space. Besides, they are maximally entangled: tracing out either qubit leaves the reduced density matrix $\rho = I/2$, where I is the identity matrix. For example, consider the Bell state $|\Phi^+\rangle_{AB}$, then the corresponding density matrix is $\rho_{AB} = |\Phi^+\rangle\langle\Phi^+|$. Now, if we only look at the qubit A subsystem, we trace out qubit B to get the reduced density matrix as

$$\rho_A = \text{tr}_B(\rho_{AB}) = \frac{I_A}{2}. \quad (5)$$

Similarly, we have $\rho_B = \frac{I_B}{2}$. This implies that when measuring either qubit, we get equal probability of getting $|0\rangle$ or $|1\rangle$. However, the measurement results of system A and system B are perfectly correlated. For example, if system A measure the entangled state and gets $|0\rangle$, then B gets $|0\rangle$. Similarly, if A obtains $|1\rangle$, then B gets $|1\rangle$. That is, each local measurement result is random, but it becomes highly correlated once we look at the system as a whole.

C. Quantum Measurement and Bell Measurement

The projection postulate state that measurement irreversibly collapses the superposition state into one of its components [3]. Therefore, measurement on the qubit is a physical process that will disturb the original state. A projective measurement is described by a Hermitian observable $M = \sum_m m P_m$, where $\{P_m\}$ are orthogonal projection operator onto the eigenspace of M with eigenvalue m and satisfy $\sum_m P_m = I$ and $P_m P_{m'} = \delta_{mm'} P_m$. Given a pure state $|\psi\rangle$, the probability of obtaining outcome m is

$$p(m) = \langle \psi | P_m | \psi \rangle \quad (6)$$

and the post-measurement state collapses to [1]

$$|\psi_m\rangle = \frac{P_m |\psi\rangle}{\sqrt{p(m)}}. \quad (7)$$

For example, consider a qubit $|\psi\rangle = \alpha |0\rangle + \beta |1\rangle$ with $|\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1$. If we do the measurement in the computational basis $\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\}$, then the corresponding projection operators are $P_0 = |0\rangle\langle 0|$, $P_1 = |1\rangle\langle 1|$. The probability and the post-measurement states of the two possible outcomes are

$$\begin{aligned} p(0) &= \langle \psi | P_0 | \psi \rangle = |\alpha|^2, & P_0 |\psi\rangle &= |0\rangle\langle 0| (\alpha |0\rangle + \beta |1\rangle) = \alpha |0\rangle \\ p(1) &= \langle \psi | P_1 | \psi \rangle = |\beta|^2, & P_1 |\psi\rangle &= |1\rangle\langle 1| (\alpha |0\rangle + \beta |1\rangle) = \beta |1\rangle. \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

Therefore, a direct measurement gives either 0 or 1, and the original coefficients disappear due to the normalization (Equation 7), and thus the original qubit state is no longer available. In order to maintain the original qubit state, in quantum teleportation, a Bell measurement is performed on a two-qubit system. Similar to the projective measurement, we define the

Bell-measurement projectors as

$$P_k = |\beta_k\rangle \langle \beta_k|, \quad |\beta_k\rangle \in \{|\Psi^\pm\rangle, |\Phi^\pm\rangle\}. \quad (9)$$

Thus, a Bell measurement yields one of the Bell states. That is, computational-basis measurement tells us whether each qubit is individually in $|0\rangle$ or $|1\rangle$, while a Bell measurement implies which Bell state the two-qubit system occupies as a whole.

D. Pauli Operators and Unitary Correction

The Pauli operators are a set of 2×2 unitary matrices forming a basis for the space of single-qubit operators [1]:

$$\begin{aligned} I &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, & X &= \sigma_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \\ Z &= \sigma_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, & Y &= \sigma_2 = iXZ = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -i \\ i & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \quad (10)$$

These are the standard single-qubit Pauli operators used in the quantum information. In particular, X is a bit-flip operator ($X|0\rangle = |1\rangle$, $X|1\rangle = |0\rangle$), Z acts as a phase-flip operator ($Z|0\rangle = |0\rangle$, $Z|1\rangle = -|1\rangle$), while Y is the same operator as XZ up to a phase factor. Therefore, we will just use XZ in the later protocol operation. These four operators $\{I, X, Z, XZ\}$ will serve as the unitary correction operators for Bob to recover the original quantum state after Alice's Bell measurement.

III. STANDARD QUANTUM TELEPORTATION PROTOCOL

In this chapter, we use the mathematical tools introduced in the previous chapter to derive the standard quantum teleportation protocol. The goal of the protocol is to transfer an unknown quantum state from Alice to Bob without physically sending the original qubit through a quantum channel. Instead, the protocol uses one shared Bell pair, one Bell measurement, two bits of classical communication, and a conditional Pauli correction.

Suppose Alice has an unknown qubit state

$$|\psi\rangle_1 = \alpha|0\rangle_1 + \beta|1\rangle_1, \quad |\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1. \quad (11)$$

Here the subscript 1 labels the unknown input qubit. Alice does not know the coefficients, and she may not measure it directly as the post-measurement state would collapse. Therefore, Alice and Bob share an entangled Bell pair, say

$$|\Phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle_{23} + |11\rangle_{23}), \quad (12)$$

where qubit 2 and 3 are held by Alice and Bob respectively. The total initial state of the three-qubit system is

$$\begin{aligned} |\Psi\rangle_{123} &= |\psi\rangle_1 |\Phi^+\rangle_{23} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (\alpha|000\rangle_{123} + \alpha|011\rangle_{123} + \beta|100\rangle_{123} + \beta|111\rangle_{123}), \end{aligned} \quad (13)$$

where in the second line of the equation we expand the total qubit state. Since Alice will perform a Bell measurement on qubit 1 and 2, this suggests us to express the computational basis $|\rangle_{12}$ in terms of the Bell states as

$$\begin{aligned} |00\rangle_{12} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\Phi^+\rangle_{12} + |\Phi^-\rangle_{12}), & |11\rangle_{12} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\Phi^+\rangle_{12} - |\Phi^-\rangle_{12}), \\ |01\rangle_{12} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\Psi^+\rangle_{12} + |\Psi^-\rangle_{12}), & |10\rangle_{12} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\Psi^+\rangle_{12} - |\Psi^-\rangle_{12}). \end{aligned} \quad (14)$$

Thus, the total state becomes

$$|\psi\rangle_1 |\Phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{2} \left[|\Phi^+\rangle_{12} (\alpha |0\rangle_3 + \beta |1\rangle_3) + |\Phi^-\rangle_{12} (\alpha |0\rangle_3 - \beta |1\rangle_3) \right. \\ \left. + |\Psi^+\rangle_{12} (\beta |0\rangle_3 + \alpha |1\rangle_3) + |\Psi^-\rangle_{12} (-\beta |0\rangle_3 + \alpha |1\rangle_3) \right]. \quad (15)$$

We may further rewrite this expression using the Pauli operators as

$$|\psi\rangle_1 |\Phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{2} \left[|\Phi^+\rangle_{12} |\psi\rangle_3 + |\Phi^-\rangle_{12} Z |\psi\rangle_3 + |\Psi^+\rangle_{12} X |\psi\rangle_3 + |\Psi^-\rangle_{12} XZ |\psi\rangle_3 \right]. \quad (16)$$

This equation is the central identity of quantum teleportation. It shows that when qubits 1 and 2 are written in the Bell basis, Bob's qubit 3 is related to the original input state by one of four possible Pauli operations. Alice now perform a Bell measurement on qubits 1 and 2. According to the projection postulate, the total state collapses into one of the four Bell states with equal probability. If Alice obtains the outcome $|\Phi^+\rangle_{12}$, then Bob's qubit is simply $|\psi\rangle_3$. With no extra correction, the unknown qubit is teleported to Bob. If Alice get $|\Phi^-\rangle_{12}$, then Bob's qubit is $Z |\psi\rangle_3$. Bob need to apply Z so that $Z(Z |\psi\rangle_3) = Z^2 |\psi\rangle_3 = |\psi\rangle_3$. Similarly, if Alice obtains $|\Psi^+\rangle_{12}$, Bob gets $X |\psi\rangle_3$ and need to perform X so that $X(X |\psi\rangle_3) = X^2 |\psi\rangle_3 = |\psi\rangle_3$. Finally, if Alice obtains $|\Psi^-\rangle_{12}$, Bob apply ZX such that $ZX(XZ |\psi\rangle_3) = |\psi\rangle_3$. These four cases can be summarized into the following table as

Alice's Bell outcome	Bob's state before correction	Bob's correction
$ \Phi^+\rangle_{12}$	$ \psi\rangle_3$	I
$ \Phi^-\rangle_{12}$	$Z \psi\rangle_3$	Z
$ \Psi^+\rangle_{12}$	$X \psi\rangle_3$	X
$ \Psi^-\rangle_{12}$	$XZ \psi\rangle_3$	ZX

(17)

After Alice's measurement, she need to tell Bob which one of these four Bell states she got. Since one classical bit has two possible values, 0 and 1, two classical bits can represent four possible messages: 00, 01, 10, and 11. This is enough to label the four Bell-measurement outcomes. For example, they may agree that 00 corresponds to $|\Phi^+\rangle_{12}$. That is, with a two-classical-bit channel, Alice can transport her measurement result to Bob so that he can perform the corresponding correction operation to get the original unknown qubit state. In

source language, the teleportation protocol can be summarized as

$$1 \text{ ebit} + 2 \text{ classical bits} \rightarrow 1 \text{ transmitted qubit.} \quad (18)$$

IV. PHYSICAL MEANING AND EXPERIMENTAL RELEVANCE

After deriving the standard teleportation protocol, it is important to clarify what the protocol does and does not imply physically. Quantum teleportation transfers an unknown quantum state from Alice's qubit to Bob's qubit, but it does not transfer matter, does not create a second copy of the state, and does not allow faster-than-light communication. The protocol works only because of the shared entangled pair and a classical bit channel. In this section, we discuss these physical implications and then connect the ideal protocol to experimental realization.

A. No-Cloning

Quantum teleportation does not create a second copy of the unknown quantum state. Although Bob's final qubit becomes $|\psi\rangle_3 = \alpha|0\rangle_3 + \beta|1\rangle_3$, Alice's original qubit is no longer available after the Bell measurement. The Bell measurement projects qubits 1 and 2 into one of the four Bell states, and therefore irreversibly destroys the original unknown state on Alice's side. This is why quantum teleportation is consistent with the no-cloning theorem. The no-cloning theorem, first formulated by Wootters and Zurek [4] and independently by Dieks [5], states that it is impossible to make an exact copy of an arbitrary unknown quantum state. The proof is straightforward. Suppose there exists a universal unitary cloning machine U such that $U|\psi\rangle|s\rangle = |\psi\rangle|\psi\rangle$ for any unknown state $|\psi\rangle$, where $|s\rangle$ is a blank initial state. If the same machine can also clone another state $|\phi\rangle$, then $U|\phi\rangle|s\rangle = |\phi\rangle|\phi\rangle$. Taking the inner product of these two equations gives $\langle\psi|\phi\rangle = \langle\psi|\phi\rangle^2$. This condition is only satisfied when $\langle\psi|\phi\rangle = 0$ or $\langle\psi|\phi\rangle = 1$. In other words, the two states must be either orthogonal or identical. Therefore, no single unitary operation can clone an arbitrary unknown quantum state [1].

Teleportation avoids this contradiction because it does not copy the state. Instead, the quantum information initially contained in qubit 1 is transferred to qubit 3, while the original state at Alice's side is destroyed by measurement. Therefore, teleportation should be understood as state transfer rather than state duplication.

B. No Faster-Than-Light Communication

Quantum teleportation also does not allow faster-than-light communication. Although the shared Bell pair provides nonclassical correlations between Alice and Bob, Bob cannot recover the unknown state before receiving Alice's classical message. That is, Bob needs Alice's message so that he knows what operation he should apply to recover the unknown qubit. This can be made more precise by looking at Bob's reduced density matrix before the classical message arrives. Since the four Bell-measurement outcomes occur with equal probability, Bob's local state is an average over the four possible states:

$$\rho_3 = \frac{1}{4} (|\psi\rangle\langle\psi| + Z|\psi\rangle\langle\psi|Z + X|\psi\rangle\langle\psi|X + XZ|\psi\rangle\langle\psi|ZX). \quad (19)$$

For an arbitrary qubit $|\psi\rangle = \alpha|0\rangle + \beta|1\rangle$, this average becomes

$$\rho_3 = \frac{I}{2}. \quad (20)$$

Thus, before receiving Alice's classical message, Bob's local state is completely mixed and independent of α and β . Any measurement Bob performs locally gives random results and reveals no information about the unknown input state. Bennett et al. [2] emphasized this point in the original teleportation paper: if Bob tries to complete the protocol by guessing Alice's classical message before it arrives, his state is only a maximally mixed state and gives no information about the input state.

C. Security of the Classical Message

V. EXPERIMENTAL IMPLEMENTATION VIA DUAL-PHOTON ENTANGLEMENT

A. The Quantum Leap from Theory to Lab

The 1998 experiment by Boschi et al. marked a paradigm shift in realizing quantum information protocols. While the canonical Bennett et al. (1993) model required three independent photons—posing formidable temporal synchronization hurdles—this design utilized a sophisticated two-photon, dual-degree-of-freedom architecture. By exploiting both the momentum (path or k -vector) and polarization of a single entangled photon pair, researchers accessed a four-dimensional Hilbert space ($2 \text{ paths} \times 2 \text{ polarizations}$) within a bipartite system. This architectural innovation addressed two primary limitations of prior configurations:

- **100% Success Rate in Bell State Measurement:** Unlike linear-optics three-photon schemes (bounded by a 50% success rate), this approach permits projection onto the complete Bell basis, enabling the deterministic identification of all four states simultaneously.
- **Elimination of Three-Photon Coincidence Hurdles:** Deriving the entire process from a single entangled photon pair (EPR source) circumvents the prohibitive difficulty of synchronizing independent sources within sub-nanosecond coincidence windows.

The physical execution initiates at the EPR source, where the non-local quantum channel is established.

B. Implementation of the Dual-Degree-of-Freedom Setup

1. The EPR Source: Converting Light into Entanglement

Entanglement is generated via Type-II spontaneous parametric down-conversion (SPDC). Specifically, a 200 mW, 351.1 nm ultraviolet argon laser pumps a β -barium borate (BBO) crystal, producing polarization-entangled photon pairs at 702.2 nm. To facilitate the dual-degree architecture, this initial polarization entanglement is deterministically converted into

spatial path entanglement via birefringent calcite crystals (C), which split the incident photons into discrete spatial paths (a and b). The resulting EPR state is described by:

$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|a_1\rangle|a_2\rangle + |b_1\rangle|b_2\rangle)$$

Crucially, photon 1 is routed toward Alice's station, while photon 2 traverses backreflected paths a_2 and b_2 through the BBO crystal toward Bob.

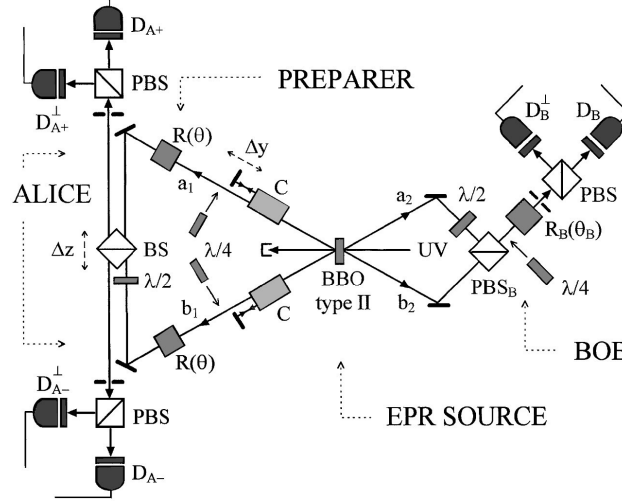


FIG. 2: Diagram of experimental setup showing the separate roles of the preparer, Alice, and Bob.

2. The Preparer: Encoding the Unknown State

A strict logical distinction is maintained between the Preparer and Alice. To ensure the state $|\phi\rangle$ remains fundamentally "unknown," the Preparer encodes it onto photon 1's polarization before it reaches Alice's apparatus. This relies on local unitary operations on paths a_1 and b_1 :

- **Polarization Initialization:** Photon 1 enters with an initial defined polarization (typically vertical, $|v\rangle_1$).
- **Unitary Manipulation:** Quarter-wave plates and Fresnel rhomb rotators (R) transform this into a general pure state: $|\phi\rangle = \alpha|v\rangle_1 + \beta|h\rangle_1$.
- **Path Independence:** Operating identically on paths a_1 and b_1 , the polarization state effectively factors out of the path entanglement.

This yields a global tripartite system where the unknown polarization is carried by the path-entangled photon 1:

$$|\Psi_{total}\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|a_1\rangle|a_2\rangle + |b_1\rangle|b_2\rangle)(\alpha|v\rangle_1 + \beta|h\rangle_1)|h\rangle_2$$

3. *Alice's BSM Engine: Interferometric Bell State Measurement*

Alice's Bell State Measurement (BSM) interferometer projects photon 1's bipartite state onto four orthogonal path-polarization Bell states:

$$|c^\pm\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|a_1\rangle|v\rangle_1 \pm |b_1\rangle|h\rangle_1)$$

$$|d^\pm\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|a_1\rangle|h\rangle_1 \pm |b_1\rangle|v\rangle_1)$$

Prior to entering a 50:50 beam splitter (BS), a Fresnel rhomb in path b_1 induces a 90° polarization rotation. This ensures path and polarization degrees of freedom are properly aligned for interference. The BS then acts as a unitary operator, mapping distinct path-polarization correlations to specific output ports.

The BS is mounted on a micrometrical stage to precisely tune the path-length difference (Δz). Alignment is confirmed by "interference dips" in coincidence count rates, signifying spatiotemporal wave packet overlap.

Mechanics of Detection: Polarizing beam splitters (PBS) sort the emerging photons into four avalanche photodiode detectors ($D_{A+}, D_{A+}^\perp, D_{A-}, D_{A-}^\perp$). Detector coincidences unambiguously project onto the Bell basis:

- A detection at $D_{A+}^\perp$ or $D_{A-}^\perp$ identifies states $|c^\pm\rangle$.
- A detection at D_{A+} or D_{A-} identifies states $|d^\pm\rangle$.

This projective measurement dictates the unitary operation Bob must perform to reconstruct the initial state.

4. Bob's Station: Reconstructing the Teleported State

At the receiving station, photon 2 arrives via trajectories a_2 and b_2 . To resolve the path entanglement, polarization in path a_2 is orthogonally rotated by 90° via a half-wave plate before recombining with path b_2 at the polarizing beam splitter (PBS_B).

Bob employs *passive reconstruction*. Rather than dynamically rotating the state using active electro-optic switches, he reorients his measurement basis to verify the teleported state based on Alice's classical transmission.

Unitary Transformation Logic:

- **Linear States:** Bob adjusts his Fresnel rhomb (R_B) to an angle θ_B , determined by Alice's Bell state outcome.
- **Elliptical States:** Bob inserts a quarter-wave plate at angle γ_B to map the expected elliptical state back into an observable linear basis.
- **Phase Matching:** Bob uses a micrometrical stage to tune Δy , ensuring paths satisfy the phase-matching criteria for high-fidelity verification.

C. The Verdict: Beating the Classical Limit

To rigorously validate quantum teleportation, the experimental fidelity (S)—representing the average probability of the teleported state passing verification—must strictly exceed the classical communication limit of 0.75. Surpassing this threshold empirically proves that entanglement was utilized as a non-local resource. In the 1998 experiment, S was derived through a comprehensive sampling process across three equally spaced linear polarization settings (0° , 120° , and -120°). To ensure a representative result on the Bloch sphere, each of these three states was assigned a weight of $1/3$, while each of the four possible Bell state measurement outcomes was weighted equally at $1/4$. The final observed fidelity of 0.853 ± 0.012 exceeds the classical bound by eight standard deviations. This result robustly confirms that the dual-degree-of-freedom architecture functioned as a unified quantum processor, providing definitive empirical proof of the successful teleportation of unknown pure quantum states.

VI. VARIANTS OF QUANTUM TELEPORTATION

A. Optical Modes System: Continuous-Variable Teleportation

In the previous chapter, we explored the standard quantum teleportation protocol, which is based on discrete-variable (DV) systems and uses photonic qubits as the information carriers. Now, it is reasonable to ask the following question: can we construct a teleportation protocol in an infinite-dimensional Hilbert space instead of only a two-dimensional one?

The answer is yes. Instead of encoding quantum information in a two-level system such as eq.1. Continuous-variable (CV) teleportation uses quantum states of optical modes. A single optical mode is mathematically equivalent to a quantum harmonic oscillator, whose Hilbert space is spanned by the infinite set of Fock states

$$|0\rangle, |1\rangle, |2\rangle, \dots \quad (21)$$

Therefore, the state to be teleported is no longer restricted to a qubit. It can be an arbitrary state of one mode of the electromagnetic field, described by continuous quadrature variables.

For an optical mode with annihilation operator $\hat{a}$, we define the field quadratures

$$\hat{x} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\hat{a} + \hat{a}^\dagger), \quad \hat{p} = \frac{1}{i\sqrt{2}}(\hat{a} - \hat{a}^\dagger), \quad (22)$$

which are analogous to the position and momentum operators of a harmonic oscillator. These two variables satisfy the canonical commutation relation

$$[\hat{x}, \hat{p}] = i. \quad (23)$$

A quantum state of the optical mode can then be represented in phase space by a Wigner function

$$W_{\text{in}}(x, p), \quad (24)$$

or equivalently by using the complex amplitude

$$\alpha = x + ip. \quad (25)$$

The key resource in continuous-variable teleportation is not a Bell pair of qubits, but a two-mode squeezed state. This state plays the role of an EPR pair. In the ideal EPR limit, the two modes have perfect correlations between their quadratures. In the convention used by Braunstein and Kimble, the ideal correlations are roughly

$$x_1 + x_2 \rightarrow 0, \quad p_1 - p_2 \rightarrow 0. \quad (26)$$

This means that if Alice measures one part of the entangled pair, Bob's mode is strongly correlated with it. However, perfect EPR correlation would require infinite squeezing and therefore infinite energy. In any real experiment, the squeezing is finite, so the teleportation can only be approximate.

The teleportation protocol proceeds as follows. Alice is given an unknown input state

$$W_{\text{in}}(\alpha_{\text{in}}), \quad (27)$$

which she wants to teleport to Bob. Alice and Bob also share a two-mode squeezed EPR state. Alice holds mode 1 and Bob holds mode 2.

First, Alice combines the unknown input mode with her half of the EPR pair on a 50/50 beam splitter. The beam splitter produces two output modes,

$$\hat{a}_a = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\hat{a}_1 + \hat{a}_{\text{in}}), \quad \hat{a}_b = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\hat{a}_1 - \hat{a}_{\text{in}}). \quad (28)$$

She then performs balanced homodyne measurements on these two modes. Specifically, she measures the quadrature combinations

$$x_a = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(x_1 + x_{\text{in}}), \quad (29)$$

and

$$p_b = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(p_1 - p_{\text{in}}). \quad (30)$$

These measurement outcomes are ordinary classical numbers. Alice sends the values of x_a and p_b to Bob through a classical communication channel.

After receiving Alice's measurement results, Bob applies a phase-space displacement to

his optical mode. In terms of the complex amplitude, this displacement can be written as

$$\alpha_{\text{out}} = \alpha_2 + \sqrt{2}(x_a - ip_b). \quad (31)$$

Using the EPR correlations $x_1 + x_2 \approx 0$ and $p_1 - p_2 \approx 0$, we can see why this reconstructs the input state. For the x quadrature,

$$x_{\text{out}} = x_2 + \sqrt{2}x_a = x_2 + x_1 + x_{\text{in}} \approx x_{\text{in}}. \quad (32)$$

Similarly, for the p quadrature,

$$p_{\text{out}} = p_2 - \sqrt{2}p_b = p_2 - p_1 + p_{\text{in}} \approx p_{\text{in}}. \quad (33)$$

Thus, Bob's output mode becomes a copy of Alice's unknown input state, up to the error caused by finite squeezing and imperfect detection.

The most important result is that the output Wigner function is the input Wigner function convolved with a Gaussian noise function:

$$W_{\text{out}}(\alpha) = W_{\text{in}}(\alpha) * G_s(\alpha). \quad (34)$$

Here, G_s is a Gaussian distribution whose variance is determined by the amount of squeezing. For ideal detection,

$$s = e^{-2r}, \quad (35)$$

where r is the squeezing parameter. Therefore, in the limit of infinite squeezing,

$$r \rightarrow \infty, \quad e^{-2r} \rightarrow 0, \quad (36)$$

the Gaussian noise vanishes and the output state becomes exactly equal to the input state:

$$W_{\text{out}}(\alpha) \rightarrow W_{\text{in}}(\alpha). \quad (37)$$

This is the ideal continuous-variable teleportation limit.

For realistic detectors, the output contains additional noise due to imperfect detection

efficiency. If the detector amplitude efficiency is η , the effective noise becomes

$$\bar{s} = e^{-2r} + \frac{1 - \eta^2}{\eta^2}. \quad (38)$$

This equation shows the two main limitations of practical CV teleportation: finite squeezing and detector loss. Increasing the squeezing reduces the first term, while improving the homodyne detection efficiency reduces the second term.

A useful way to understand this result is to compare quantum teleportation with a purely classical strategy. If there is no entanglement, corresponding to $r = 0$, Alice can only measure the input state and tell Bob what state to prepare. However, because $\hat{x}$ and $\hat{p}$ do not commute, Alice cannot measure both quadratures perfectly at the same time. The measurement necessarily adds quantum noise. Bob's reconstruction also adds noise. Therefore, the classical measure-and-prepare protocol cannot perfectly reproduce the input quantum state. In contrast, when $r > 0$, Alice and Bob share genuine EPR entanglement, and the teleportation fidelity can exceed the classical limit.

Physically, this protocol is attractive because all the required operations can be implemented with standard quantum optical tools. The two-mode squeezed state can be generated using parametric down-conversion or an optical parametric amplifier. The mixing operation is performed with a 50/50 beam splitter. The quadrature measurements are performed using balanced homodyne detection. Finally, Bob's phase-space displacement can be implemented by combining his mode with a strong coherent field.

The important conceptual difference between DV and CV teleportation is that the classical information sent by Alice is also continuous. In qubit teleportation, Alice sends two classical bits. In continuous-variable teleportation, Alice sends two real numbers, corresponding to the measured quadratures x_a and p_b . These values tell Bob how much he must displace his optical mode in phase space.

In summary, continuous-variable teleportation extends the original teleportation idea from finite-dimensional qubits to infinite-dimensional optical modes. The unknown state is encoded in the quadrature amplitudes of an electromagnetic field mode. Alice performs a joint measurement between the input state and her half of an EPR-like two-mode squeezed state, sends the continuous measurement results to Bob, and Bob applies a displacement operation to reconstruct the state. The quality of teleportation is limited by finite squeezing

and detector inefficiency, but with sufficient squeezing the protocol can teleport genuinely nonclassical optical states with fidelity beyond any classical measure-and-prepare scheme.

B. Atomic Ensemble Systems

Atomic ensembles provide an important platform for quantum teleportation because they naturally combine a flying quantum system, light, with a stationary quantum system, matter. In a quantum network, photons are well suited for transmitting quantum information over long distances, while atoms are better suited for storing quantum information locally. An atomic ensemble acts as a collective quantum memory: instead of encoding the state in one single atom, the relevant quantum information is stored in a collective excitation shared coherently among many atoms. This collective enhancement increases the effective light-matter coupling and makes atomic ensembles useful for quantum repeaters and long-distance quantum communication.

There are two major ways in which atomic ensembles are used in teleportation experiments. The first is a continuous-variable approach, where the quantum state of an optical mode is teleported onto the collective spin quadratures of an atomic ensemble. The second is a discrete-variable approach, where a photonic qubit or a spin-wave qubit is teleported using single-photon detection and heralded entanglement. Although the physical implementation is different, both approaches follow the same basic teleportation protocol: an entangled resource is first created, a Bell-type measurement is performed, the measurement result is sent through a classical channel, and the receiver applies a conditional operation to recover the input quantum state.

A representative continuous-variable experiment was demonstrated by Sherson *et al.*, where a quantum state of light was teleported onto a macroscopic ensemble containing approximately 10^{12} cesium atoms [6]. The atoms were placed in a paraffin-coated vapor cell at room temperature and optically pumped into a coherent spin state. Since the collective spin was strongly polarized along one direction, the two transverse spin components could be treated as canonical variables,

$$\hat{X}_A = \frac{\hat{J}_y^{\text{rot}}}{\sqrt{J_x}}, \quad \hat{P}_A = \frac{\hat{J}_z^{\text{rot}}}{\sqrt{J_x}}, \quad (39)$$

where J_x is the large mean collective spin. These variables obey approximately the canonical commutation relation

$$[\hat{X}_A, \hat{P}_A] = i, \quad (40)$$

which allows the atomic ensemble to be described in the same language as the quadratures of an optical field.

The entanglement between light and atoms is generated by sending a strong off-resonant light pulse through the atomic sample. Through a Faraday-type interaction, the polarization quadratures of the outgoing light become correlated with the collective spin variables of the atoms. Physically, the atomic spin causes a polarization rotation of the light, while the light also acts back on the atomic spin through the ac Stark effect. In this way, the outgoing optical pulse and the atomic ensemble become entangled.

After the light–matter entanglement is created, the outgoing light pulse is sent to Alice, where it is mixed on a 50/50 beamsplitter with the unknown input light state to be teleported. Alice then performs a Bell measurement using polarization homodyne detection. The measurement produces classical photocurrents containing information about the difference and sum of the relevant optical quadratures. These classical signals are sent to Bob, who applies radio-frequency magnetic-field pulses to the atomic ensemble. These pulses rotate the collective spin and displace the atomic variables according to the Bell measurement result.

Ideally, after the feed-forward operation, the original optical quadratures are mapped onto the atomic quadratures,

$$\hat{Y}, \hat{Q} \longrightarrow \hat{X}_A^{\text{tele}}, \hat{P}_A^{\text{tele}}. \quad (41)$$

Here $\hat{Y}$ and $\hat{Q}$ are the quadrature operators of the input light field, while $\hat{X}_A^{\text{tele}}$ and $\hat{P}_A^{\text{tele}}$ are the final teleported atomic spin variables. The optical state is therefore not physically absorbed in the usual classical sense. Instead, the combination of pre-existing light–matter entanglement, Bell measurement, classical communication, and spin displacement allows the atomic ensemble to reproduce the quantum state initially carried by the light.

The success of teleportation is quantified by the fidelity between the input state and the reconstructed atomic state. In the experiment of Sherson *et al.*, deterministic teleportation was achieved for coherent optical states with mean photon numbers up to a few hundred.

The reported fidelities were

$$F = 0.60 \pm 0.02 \quad \text{for} \quad \bar{n} = 5, \quad (42)$$

and

$$F = 0.58 \pm 0.02 \quad \text{for} \quad \bar{n} = 20. \quad (43)$$

These values exceeded the corresponding classical benchmarks, showing that the process was genuinely quantum rather than a classical measure-and-prepare transfer [6]. The final atomic state was verified by sending a second strong pulse through the ensemble and reconstructing the atomic quadratures from the transmitted light.

Although the receiving system contained a macroscopic number of atoms, the teleported excitation itself corresponded only to the number of photons in the input optical state. This means that the quantum information was stored as a small collective excitation distributed over the entire ensemble. No individual atom carried the whole state. This collective feature is one of the central advantages of atomic ensembles: many atoms cooperate to form one effective quantum memory.

A second approach uses discrete-variable spin-wave excitations. In this case, the ensemble is initially prepared with all atoms in a ground state $|g\rangle$. A weak write pulse can create a Stokes photon together with one collective excitation in another long-lived atomic state $|s\rangle$. The single spin-wave excitation can be written as

$$|1\rangle_{\text{sw}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{N}} \sum_{j=1}^N e^{i\mathbf{k}_{\text{sw}} \cdot \mathbf{r}_j} |g_1 g_2 \cdots s_j \cdots g_N\rangle, \quad (44)$$

where N is the number of atoms and $\mathbf{r}_j$ is the position of the j -th atom. The spin-wave wave vector is determined by phase matching,

$$\mathbf{k}_{\text{sw}} = \mathbf{k}_{\text{write}} - \mathbf{k}_{\text{Stokes}}. \quad (45)$$

This phase factor is physically important because it determines the spatial mode of the collective excitation and therefore the direction in which the stored excitation can later be read out as a photon.

During the read process, a read pulse converts the spin wave back into an anti-Stokes

photon. The phase-matching condition gives

$$\mathbf{k}_{\text{anti-Stokes}} = \mathbf{k}_{\text{read}} + \mathbf{k}_{\text{sw}}. \quad (46)$$

Therefore, the geometry of the write and read beams directly controls the memory mode and retrieval direction. Atomic motion can destroy the phase coherence of the spin wave, especially when $\mathbf{k}_{\text{sw}}$ is large. For this reason, cold atomic ensembles, small spin-wave wave vectors, and carefully chosen beam geometries are often used to improve the memory lifetime.

The discrete-variable approach is closely related to the DLCZ quantum repeater protocol [7]. In this scheme, entanglement between remote atomic ensembles is generated probabilistically. A weak write pulse creates a photon–spin-wave pair with small probability. Detection of the emitted photon heralds the presence of a collective spin excitation. By interfering photons emitted from two remote ensembles on a beamsplitter, one can herald entanglement between the two distant atomic memories. Once entanglement is established, teleportation can be performed by a Bell-state measurement involving the input qubit and one part of the entangled resource.

Several experiments have demonstrated this idea. In memory-built-in teleportation, an unknown photonic polarization qubit can be teleported onto a remote atomic ensemble and stored as a collective spin-wave excitation [8]. In another experiment, teleportation was demonstrated between two remote atomic-ensemble quantum memories connected by optical fiber [9]. These experiments show that atomic ensembles are not merely passive receivers of quantum states; they can function as active nodes in a quantum network, capable of storing, retrieving, and distributing quantum information.

The continuous-variable and discrete-variable approaches have complementary strengths. Continuous-variable teleportation can be deterministic and naturally uses homodyne detection, making it well suited for Gaussian optical states. However, high fidelity requires strong light–matter coupling, low optical loss, accurate feed-forward, and long atomic coherence time. Discrete-variable teleportation is naturally compatible with single-photon qubits and heralded quantum repeaters, but it is usually probabilistic because successful teleportation depends on photon detection events. In both cases, the main imperfections are optical loss, detector inefficiency, atomic decoherence, mode mismatch, and imperfect state preparation.

Overall, atomic ensemble systems are important because they provide a practical interface

between flying photonic qubits and stationary matter-based quantum memories. They allow quantum information to be transferred from light to matter, stored for a finite time, and later retrieved as light again. This makes them especially relevant for quantum repeaters, where long-distance quantum communication requires both transmission and memory. Atomic ensembles therefore represent one of the most promising physical platforms for building scalable quantum networks.

C. Solid-State System

VII. ADVANCES IN QUANTUM TELEPORTATION

A. Quantum Teleportation for Quantum Communication

One of the most important advances of quantum teleportation is its application to long-distance quantum communication. In ordinary communication, information is carried by a physical signal, such as an electromagnetic wave or an optical pulse. However, when the information is an unknown quantum state, it cannot simply be measured and copied because of the no-cloning theorem. Quantum teleportation provides a way to transfer this unknown state from one system to another by using two resources: a shared entangled state and a classical communication channel.

A clear experimental example is the ground-to-satellite quantum teleportation experiment performed using the Micius satellite [10]. In this experiment, the quantum state to be teleported was encoded in the polarization of a single photon,

$$|\chi\rangle_1 = \alpha |H\rangle_1 + \beta |V\rangle_1, \quad |\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1, \quad (47)$$

where $|H\rangle$ and $|V\rangle$ represent horizontal and vertical polarization. These two polarization states play the role of the qubit basis states $|0\rangle$ and $|1\rangle$. The ground station also prepared an entangled photon pair in the Bell state

$$|\phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|H\rangle_2 |H\rangle_3 + |V\rangle_2 |V\rangle_3). \quad (48)$$

Photon 2 remained at the ground station, while photon 3 was sent through a free-space

optical uplink to the satellite. The ground station then performed a Bell-state measurement on photons 1 and 2. Depending on the Bell-state measurement result, the state of photon 3 became either the desired state $|\chi\rangle$, or a state related to it by a known unitary correction such as a π -phase shift. Therefore, the unknown quantum state was not physically carried by photon 1 to the satellite; instead, it was reconstructed in the distant photon 3 by using entanglement plus classical information.

This experiment is important because it addresses the main difficulty of long-distance quantum communication: photon loss. Previous teleportation experiments using optical fibers or terrestrial free-space channels were limited to roughly the hundred-kilometer scale because loss increases strongly with distance. A satellite link reduces this problem because most of the propagation path is through empty space rather than through an absorbing medium. In the Micius experiment, the teleportation distance varied from about 500 km to 1400 km, with a measured channel loss ranging from about 41 dB to 52 dB. Even with this large loss, the experiment successfully teleported six input states chosen from mutually unbiased bases on the Bloch sphere:

$$|H\rangle, \quad |V\rangle, \quad |+\rangle, \quad |-\rangle, \quad |R\rangle, \quad |L\rangle.$$

The measured average teleportation fidelity was

$$F = 0.80 \pm 0.01,$$

which is clearly above the classical limit of $2/3$. This means that the result cannot be explained by a classical strategy based only on measuring the input state and sending classical information.

From an experimental point of view, the propagation direction, or wave vector $\mathbf{k}$, is also crucial. The qubit itself is encoded in polarization, which is defined transverse to the photon's propagation direction. However, in a ground-to-satellite link, the direction of propagation is constantly changing because the satellite moves rapidly relative to the ground station. Atmospheric turbulence also causes beam wandering and beam broadening. Therefore, the experiment required a narrow-divergence transmitting telescope and a precise acquiring, pointing, and tracking system. In addition, polarization compensation using wave plates

was needed so that the polarization qubit remained well-defined during transmission.

This result shows that quantum teleportation is not only a conceptual consequence of entanglement, but also a practical building block for a future quantum internet. In such a network, teleportation could be combined with entanglement distribution, quantum memories, and entanglement swapping to connect distant quantum nodes. The ground-to-satellite experiment is therefore an important step from laboratory teleportation toward global-scale quantum communication.

B. Quantum Gate Teleportation for Quantum Computing

VIII. CONCLUSION

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